

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Image Editing

The whole point of a digital camera is to just point and take pictures, right? Who needs to know about all those fancy adjustments you can make? But if you want to sound like the know-it-all pro of digital image editing... read on.

Hue: One of the main colour attributes—apart from the “lightness” and “colourfulness”—of an image, hue is associated with the colours red and yellow: when the hue is edited, it’s like putting a film of coloured plastic over the image.

Saturation: Defined by the intensity of colour. When it is high, colours appear vivid and vibrant; when it is low, the colours take on a darker tone. If it’s too high, the image becomes “vibrant” in a psychedelic way.

Brightness: The amount of light given off by an object. Brightness is subjective: it depends on the eyes’ sensitivity to light.

Luminance: The *measurable* component of brightness. So the luminance of a bulb is the same whether it’s measured from three or 12 meters away.

Contrast: A combination of colour and brightness (woe!), contrast refers to the visual details of an image that distinguish objects in the foreground from those in the background. If an image has a lot of detail but with low lighting, increasing the contrast will improve it.

Usage: So I got this shot of a King Cobra, hood raised—right in front of me! No, really! But you couldn’t see the spots, so I tweaked the *contrast*—and I had to increase the *brightness*. Actually, the *luminance* was what needed adjustment, and the *saturation*, too—those colours! It’s got a yellowish *hue*, which I’m not touching.

Wild Wild Web

How Do Yer Do?

As fate would have it, we Astumbled upon www.rinkworks.com/dialect. And so now, we’re talking in Redneck, Pig Latin, and other such exotic dialects. Look what th’ Web hath wrought upon us: we can nae speak in homely tongue no more.

Go to that thar page and type in yer sentence. Choose yer dialect. Click the “Dialectize” button and ooh la la—th’ language of HM the Queen of Engeland you typed in has magickally mutated!

Bloody useful eh, this site? To morph an entire Web page, type in yon URL and get a dialectised view. If th’ site hath links, clicking them links will

fetch ye th’ morphed versions. Ye can now speak in Redneck (good, y’all), Jive (wassat?), Cockney (‘ow’s ‘at?), Elmer Fudd and H4x0r. (That thar last one fer ye non-techies is “hacker.” Arrr!)

Lots In A Name?

The Bard might not quite have approved, but names are worth millions on the Web. We also have a breed of hangers-on, whom the media refers to by the fancy-sounding “cyber-squatters”. But you know all that, and we’re digressing: this is not about cyber-squatters and their run-ins.

Having too much time to kill and prone as we are to

goofing off, we looked up the weirdest domain names we could find. www.mp3shits.com (get it?) is a place to go to if you want some “free” MP3s (chuckle, chuckle!).

www.whorepresents.com (wink, wink!) is a listing of contact numbers of actors and their agents. Then again, look at these gems: www.ba.be, www.glo.be, www.killbillsbrowser.com (some folks just hate IE, you know), and www.therapistfinder.com (in case you need a marital counsellor). But our site name of choice is www.losemoney-now.biz, up for sale now. Just in case you’re in the business (duh!) of losing money.

This was, as you just might have figured, reported all over the blogosphere, and quickly made it to the front pages of popular social news sites. After that, the WHOIS information for the site has been changed. P2P.net now redirects to the popular BitTorrent news site, which is full of muck about MediaDefender.

Surprisingly, the page is moderated, and there are no dirty words there.

So why did MediaDefender buy the grossly expensive P2P.net? And then decide to redirect it to TorrentFreak? It’s all twisted, warped, topsyturvy and what not, all this business about the domain name and the two Ass.es. And guess what’s on the redirected page right now? As in the comments? Here’s one: “When a digital file is illegally downloaded, NOTHING is taken. It’s copyright infringement, not theft. No matter what the smacktards in the entertainment industry would have you believe.” Ah, the same, the same, even more of the same. (Except for “smacktard,” which we’ve now learnt is a bad word meaning “retard.”) Please, please

find the February 2007 issue of *Digit* somewhere and read up on the whole P2P thing.

I'M FEELING QUIRKY

Have Net, Will Google

Most people key in search strings in a search engine when they start their amblings online. And some of these strings are weird, as you know. But some are way too weird, and looking at them makes you wonder what the users were thinking. (As in, if you’re *all* that bored, why not just Google

“sex” and get virtually laid?) Here’s a sample from a couple of blogs we found dedicated to the tracking of search behaviour that warrants urgent medical attention. Don’t say we didn’t warn you.

1. Half dog half cat
2. How to make animated movies like happy feet
3. Breed of cat in James Bond movies.
4. Haiku of Elvis Presley
5. How to make submarine with pop bottle
6. My husband wears my clothes
7. Why is my husband a jerk

A butterfly can cause a hurricane, and those folks might be reading it, so let’s tell them what Google can’t:

1. It’s going to be a bloody freak of nature. Period.
2. Feet are happy when you soak them in hot water.
3. If you care, you have no life.
4. Try one yourself if you’re so much of a fan!
5. Go back to school.
6. Eek! Period.
7. Because you don’t give him enough sex. Talking about sex, guess what: according



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